# Tongue cleaners/scrapers: HMTc Standard

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CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

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PUBLICATION HISTORY

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## Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified heavy-metal-safety standard for tongue cleaners/scrapers in Oral Care, evaluated on oral-care article as placed on market — total heavy-metal content of each accessible part, per unit mass of that component's material (ug/kg). Not a cosmetic finished-product basis, not a dietary maximum level, and not an EN 71-3 migration/leachate value.. 1 of 11 panel analytes publish a numeric limit taken from the strictest applicable government maximum; the remainder are held under mandatory control or a substantiated not-material determination.

## 1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default), Category 20 Oral Care: a formulated oral product takes the strictest applicable sovereign finished-cosmetic contaminant maximum in its as-sold basis, with the Germany BVL 2017 toothpaste tier read across to non-toothpaste oral-mucosal forms where it is stricter; an oral-care article takes the Canadian mouth-contact accessible-part lead ceiling and is otherwise held under component-level control. Species never replace totals, no ingredient purity specification anchors a finished-product cell, no migration value anchors a content cell, and no cell is occurrence-derived.

## 2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

| ANALYTE | HMTC LIMIT | BASIS |
|---|---|---|
| Lead (Pb) | 90,000 | government maximum level |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Cadmium (Cd) | 17,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Total arsenic (tAs) | 47,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Inorganic arsenic (iAs) | ≤ tAs | bounded by tAs (reflex speciation) |
| Mercury, total (tHg) | 94,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Methylmercury (MeHg) | ≤ tHg | bounded by tHg (reflex speciation) |
| Nickel (Ni) | 930,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Tin (Sn) | 180,000,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Aluminium (Al) | 28,130,000 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Total chromium (Cr) | control | measured every lot; no human-food maximum |
| Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI) | 53 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |

## 3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

| ANALYTE | HMTC | SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION |
|---|---|---|
| Lead (Pb) | 90,000 | government maximum level |
| Cadmium (Cd) | 17,000 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Total arsenic (tAs) | 47,000 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Inorganic arsenic (iAs) | ≤ tAs | iAs carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tAs (iAs <= tAs), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell. |
| Mercury, total (tHg) | 94,000 | European Union — human-food analog |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Methylmercury (MeHg) | ≤ tHg | MeHg carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tHg (MeHg <= tHg), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell. |
| Nickel (Ni) | 930,000 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Tin (Sn) | 180,000,000 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Aluminium (Al) | 28,130,000 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Total chromium (Cr) | control | No sovereign sets a total chromium content limit for a mouth-contact oral-care article. Canada's Consumer Products Containing Lead Regulations (SOR/2018-83), the only instrument scoped to mouth-contact consumer products on a total-content basis, is lead-only — as is the second article-content lead instrument named in this row's own lead cell, REACH Annex XVII entry 63(7) as added by Regulation (EU) 2015/628; the EU toy values (Directive 2009/48 / EN 71-3) are MIGRATION limits and are excluded by this row's basis guard, and finished-cosmetic impurity schedules are written for a formulated product and do not reach an article. The cell is held under mandatory analytical control, not declared not-material: chromium is a defining alloying element of the stainless steel used for staples, wires and tips and is present in chrome plating and in Cr(III) pigments; total chromium is a screen for the Cr(VI) reflex below and is not itself protective. |
| Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI) | 53 | European Union — human-food analog |

## 4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. (2026). *Tongue cleaners/scrapers: HMTc standard*. Institute of Contaminant Standards.

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## References


[1] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cd, tAs, tHg, Ni, Sn, Al, Cr-VI. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL


### STATUS AND LICENCE

A normative certification standard, editorially reviewed and version-controlled in-house; every value traces to a named sovereign maximum level, disclosed in the derivation. © 2026 Institute of Contaminant Standards / Heavy Metal Certified. All rights reserved.

### COMPETING INTERESTS

This briefing is published by the Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) program, operated by the Institute of Contaminant Standards. Its statements about government regulations, toxicology, and occurrence are sourced to the cited primary and expert-body records and to the independently maintained Heavy Metal Index; the program's own certification thresholds are not used as evidence for any factual claim made here.

### DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/tongue-cleaners-scrapers. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

### PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/tongue-cleaners-scrapers.